

Marc Guehi

ENGLAND

Age - 25

Club - Manchester City

Int. caps - 27

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When Thomas Tuchel was appointed England manager in October 2024, Marc Guehi may have felt a trace of anxiety. After all, it was the German who approved his sale from Chelsea to Crystal Palace in 2021, as he could not find minutes with the then European champion.

However, much has changed since then.

Four years on, he wore the captain's armband as Crystal Palace beat Manchester City in the FA Cup final to secure the club's first major trophy in its 164-year history. A natural leader, Guehi has earned praise for his calm and composed demeanour both on and off the ball.

Moreover, his ability to play in a back three or four, and on either side of central defence, has made him a sought-after prospect. Several big clubs pursued him in recent transfer windows, with Manchester City securing his signature in January.

In a short time under Pep Guardiola, Guehi has grown more confident on the ball while adapting to City's high defensive line.

At Euro 2024, it was Harry Maguire's injury that promoted him to a starting role — one he embraced as England reached the final before narrowly losing to Spain. While similar injury concerns linger this time, they are unlikely to define his selection. Instead, it is his defensive reliability that strengthens England's push for a first major trophy since 1966.

